Mastering Command Terms in Legal Studies

From Stating Facts to Building Judgments

01



Level 1 · Foundation

DESCRIBE / IDENTIFY · THE WHAT

CORE MEANING

State key features, characteristics or facts clearly — without giving an opinion.

PROMPT STRUCTURE

[Command Term] + [Legal Concept / Institution / Law]

RESPONSE FORMULA

Fact 1 + Fact 2 + Key Detail / Example

Thinking hint: Paint a picture with facts.

02



Level 2 · Analysis

ANALYSE / COMPARE · THE HOW & WHY

CORE MEANING

Break a concept into parts, explain relationships, or highlight similarities and differences.

PROMPT STRUCTURE

[Command Term] + [How / Why] + [Impact on Legal System]

RESPONSE FORMULA

Identify Component → Explain How / Why → Link to Impact

Thinking hint: Show how the gears connect.

03



Level 3 · Evaluation

EVALUATE / JUSTIFY · THE JUDGMENT

CORE MEANING

Weigh strengths and weaknesses and reach a justified verdict.

PROMPT STRUCTURE

[Command Term] + [Effectiveness / Value / Extent] + [Legal System / Law]

RESPONSE FORMULA

Definition → Strengths → Weaknesses → Justified Verdict

Thinking hint: Weigh the scales before landing on a verdict.

GOLDEN RULE: Match your response to the command term.